Chapter 1

The Moon Dies and Lives Again

SUMMARY. This story describes the waning of the moon as a death, and its regrowth as the promise of eternally renewed life.

SPEAKER. ǁ*Ukxa N!a'an*

RECORDED. Dobe, Botswana, 1971

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ka ha ka ku du ǁ'aka
then he did and then
!ai ǁ'aka ha n|a
died and then he certainly
to'a te ha ku ce g!a din n!ang
went over there and then he again went back
ce g!a khuinto'a
again went back to that same place over there
ka ka o g|u !om
and it was the middle of the night
ka khoe ka o djo
it was like it was black
ka ha g!a ha ha
when he went back he he
ha ge ge ka |am ku
he stayed and stayed and then the sun
n‡hao ka g!a ku g|ai
went down and then he went back and came out

okaa kahin ha ka o n!ui n!a'an
then therefore he became the big moon
o ka kahin ha ku ha g!a ku g|aia khuinto'a
it was that he had gone back to come out at that same place over there
||'a ju sa ko "uuh, a goaq ku n‡oahn,"
and the people said "ooh, you long ago told us,"
ha n!uia goaqha ku n‡oahn, o |'an ha ka !ai
the moon had long ago told them, that he would die
ka ka ha, ha koah
then then he, he shortly afterwards
o ka ha ku ku ha
it was that he was going to
'in
yes
du |'an ha ka !ai ||'an kahin ha ku ce g!a din n!ang ka
die and therefore he again went back over there and
ko ko ka kua !ai
did that and soon died
kua !ai
soon died
ee
yes